



VIRGINIA THEOLOGICAL
SEMINARY

Employee Benefits Manual

Revised January 2023

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I. INTRODUCTION

The purpose of this Staff Benefits Manual is to provide staff members detail on the benefit programs available to them through their employment with Protestant Episcopal Theological Seminary in Virginia d/b/a Virginia Theological Seminary (Seminary). The Seminary expects each of its staff members to read this Staff Benefits Manual carefully and to internalize it, as it is and will be a valuable reference in understanding the Seminary's benefits policies. All staff members are asked to read and review this manual upon receipt, as well as when they have a question about a Seminary benefit or leave policy. A copy of this manual is available in the Seminary's business office, upon request, or Human Resources (HR) Hub. Staff members must also be familiar with all Seminary policies, as a violation of Seminary policy may result in discipline, up to and including termination of employment.

This Staff Benefits Manual is the Seminary's latest version. It supersedes all previously issued Staff Benefits Manuals and inconsistent verbal or written policies or statements about policies. The Seminary reserves the right to add to, modify, suspend, rescind, delete, interpret and administer this Staff Benefits Manual, including any of the policies contained in it, at any time, with or without notice. All such additions, modifications, suspensions, rescissions or deletions must be made in writing. No oral statement or communication may change any provision of this Staff Benefits Manual.

Please note that this Staff Benefits Manual is not a contract. As such, none of the Seminary's policies or benefit plans, including those contained or described in this manual, constitute (or are intended to constitute) an express or implied contract.

This manual will be used as the essential reference for questions concerning benefits available to Seminary staff members. If a staff member has a question about this Staff Benefits Manual or a policy contained in it, a question not answered by this manual, or a question about any other Seminary policy, procedure or expectation, they are to address it with management. In addition, it is important that all staff members know the Seminary has an open door-policy that encourages every employee to bring any question or concern to management for identification, notice and resolution.

This Staff Benefits Manual is the property of Virginia Theological Seminary. It must be returned to the Seminary at the end of employment, or upon request. If this manual is lost or stolen, please inform management and ask for another copy.

II. BENEFITS

At this time, Virginia Theological Seminary offers a benefit program to all eligible staff. The following is a brief summary of the benefits currently available to regular, full-time staff members. Part-time and temporary staff members typically do not receive benefits. Part-time staff members should check with Seminary management to determine eligibility requirements for any benefits. This summary is not designed to replace actual benefit plan documents, and the Seminary reserves the right to change, amend, modify or eliminate any benefit or benefit plan, and the provisions thereof, at any time. If a plan is terminated, coverage for staff members and eligible family members will end. If there is a discrepancy between this handbook summary and the benefit plan documents, the benefit plan documents govern.

Some benefit plans contain benefit restrictions or impose information requirements. In such instances, staff members may be required to furnish this information to be eligible for coverage. If a staff member does not have access to a benefit enrollment document, he or she should contact Seminary management to obtain the desired

form or information. Staff members with questions about Seminary benefits should contact management.

Benefits. At this time, the Seminary offers the following benefits to staff members. All benefits are governed by the terms of each individual benefit plan. Staff members should consult Seminary management regarding the specific benefits available to them and the details (and eligibility periods) of those benefits.

- **Health Insurance.** The Seminary offers full-time staff members and their dependents health (including vision) and dental insurance. Participating employees contribute a portion of the premium, which is determined by the Seminary Board of Trustees and set forth in the specific insurance forms. Please see Human Resources for more information.
- **Life Insurance.** The Seminary offers full-time staff members group term life insurance in an amount equal to the staff member's annual base salary, capped at \$100,000. The Seminary purchases this insurance for participating staff members, and staff members elect the policy's beneficiary. Staff members may elect to purchase additional life insurance and bear the cost as a payroll deduction. Please see Human Resources for more information.
- **Employee Assistance Program.** The Seminary offers all full-time staff members access to a program designed to offer short-term assistance or referral when their capacity to function is impaired by personal difficulties.
- **Short-Term Disability Insurance.** The Seminary offers full-time staff members short-term disability insurance. STD coverage is available to eligible staff members should they become disabled and unable to perform their job duties. The elimination period is 14 days from the date of disability. The benefit, if approved, is paid weekly at 60% of the staff member's weekly earnings.
- **Long-Term Disability Insurance.** After a period of three months of a covered disability, an eligible staff member may receive a percentage of their regular salary from the insurance carrier, as specified in the plan documents. Staff members on LTD do not accrue vacation or other types of leave. Health insurance benefits may continue for a period of time after the staff member is approved by the Seminary's carrier for LTD. Retirement benefits for eligible staff members continue to accrue while on disability leave.
- **Workers' Compensation Insurance.** Staff members are covered by the Seminary's workers' compensation insurance, which provides medical treatment and income protection in the event an employee is involved in a covered accident or injury on the job or contracts an occupational illness. Virginia law requires that employees report workplace injuries or illnesses within 24 hours of occurrence or discovery.
- **Pension Plan.** After 3 months of service, full-time staff members are eligible to participate in a non-contributory retirement plan with TIAA.
- **Flexible Spending Accounts.** The Seminary offers two types of flexible spending accounts to eligible employees. Staff members interested in this benefit should contact the Seminary's Business Office for more information.
 - The Flexible Spending Account and the Health Savings Account allow participants to choose to have a portion of their salary reduced as a pre-tax contribution to the participant's Health Care Flexible Spending or Health Savings Account. Participants will be entitled to use the funds for eligible health care expenses incurred during the Plan Year by themselves, their spouses or their

dependents. Election into the plan must be made by December 15 for the following Plan Year, or at the time of hire.

- The Dependent Care Flexible Spending Account allows participants to choose to have a portion of their salary reduced as a pre-tax contribution to the participant's Dependent Care Flexible Spending Account. Participants may use the funds for eligible dependent care services incurred during the Plan Year. Election into the plan must be made by December 15 for the following Plan Year, or at the time of hire.
- **Long-term care insurance.** The Seminary offers full-time staff members Trustmark Universal LifeEvents with Long Term Care (LTC). This benefit is designed to help employees and their family plan for the high cost of Long-Term Care by combining the benefits of Life Insurance (death benefit for your family) with Long Term Care which can be used during your living years (helps cover cost of care for Nursing Homes, Assisted living, and In-Home Care). Virginia Theological Seminary will fund a \$25,000 benefit for all full-time employees and gives each full-time employee the opportunity to purchase a valuable Universal Life with Long-Term Care plan with group rates and limited Health Questions. Part-Time employees (working 20-29 hours per week) may apply for coverage at their own cost. The full premium amount will be taken through payroll deductions (post-tax). This benefit is portable – an employee can continue this coverage when they separate from VTS at their own cost.
- **Meals.** Lunch is generally provided for staff members during their regularly scheduled work hours, Monday through Friday, in the Refectory, during the academic year. Staff members may also, and are encouraged to, join in on other special occasions such as Community Eucharist and dinner (once a month during the academic year a community dinner is generally made available at no cost to the employee).
- **Library Privileges.** Staff members are permitted to use the Seminary Library and borrow up to 10 books and/or other Seminary Library media for 4-8 weeks. Staff members must follow all applicable library policies.
- **Education Benefits.** The Seminary supports staff members who wish to continue their education to secure increased responsibility and growth within their professional careers. Therefore, the Seminary has established a reimbursement program for approved expenses incurred through institutions of learning. Full-time staff members are eligible to participate in this program with prior approval of the Office of Finance, Administration and Operations. The courses may be through the Seminary – either academic courses or those offered in Community Evening Classes – or through another organization. The Seminary may opt to pay some or all of the costs of tuition. If a staff member resigns employment with the Seminary within one year of registering for or attending any continuing education program which the Seminary has paid for, in whole or in part, the staff member is responsible for paying back the Seminary the cost of such program and associated expenses paid by the Seminary. By the staff member's signature on the authorization form, he or she authorizes the Seminary to withhold any such money from his or her paycheck and any other funds which the Seminary owes to the staff member.

In order to receive educational assistance reimbursement, staff members should follow the following procedure:

- The staff member must provide their manager with information about the course or program for which they would like to receive reimbursement.
- The staff member must ensure that educational reimbursement is pre-approved in writing prior to enrolling in the course or program, if they expect reimbursement from the Seminary.

- The staff member must submit final grades, reflecting achievement of a Grade of C or better, to the Office of Finance, Administration and Operations.

The Seminary also grants full-time staff members enrolled in an accredited associate, bachelor's or graduate degree program who are receiving financial assistance from the Seminary to request and, at the Seminary's discretion, receive up to 12 hours of additional leave each semester of the staff member's enrollment. Supporting documentation may be required at the time of the request. All requests should go through the staff member's department head.

Effective July 1, 2023 full-time staff members who receive tuition assistance in support of graduate degree programs will be required to continue employment at the Seminary for 3 years post degree completion. If the employee resigns from the Seminary prior to the 3-year period, the employee is responsible for paying back the cost of such program (the total amount of funds received from the Seminary).

- **Loans for Dependent's Education Expenses.** Staff members with at least 10 years of employment at the Seminary may borrow up to \$20,000 (\$5,000 per year for four years) for the cost of college tuition for dependents. Tuition loans are interest free until the dependent graduates or ceases to attend on a full-time basis. The principal of the loan is due, and interest begins to accrue at the government's student loan rate, at the dependent's graduation. The full amount of the loan must be repaid within four years of the dependent's graduation, which is normally done through payroll deduction.
- **Gym Memberships.** Seminary staff members may use the athletic facilities at Episcopal High School (EHS) at no charge to the employee. Staff members using EHS facilities must follow EHS policies and procedures. The Seminary will also reimburse the employee for half the cost of an individual membership at Onelife Fitness or, if a staff member does not live within 8 miles of a Onelife Fitness. If a staff member does not live within 8 miles of any of the above listed gyms, the Seminary will reimburse the employee for the equivalent of one half of a Onelife Fitness individual membership upon a written request for gym membership fee assistance. To elect this benefit, please contact Human Resources – Payroll and Benefits Specialist. Proof of active membership may be required for each month of payment.
- **The Butterfly House.** The Seminary provides a Virginia-licensed, infant and childcare facility (up to kindergarten) for the convenience of staff members. Enrollment is on a rolling basis and depends on availability of space within the program. Tuition for staff is discounted on a sliding scale, depending on the staff member's compensation. The Director of the Butterfly House can provide eligible staff members with the applicable rates.

III. LEAVES OF ABSENCE

In addition to the leaves of absence set out in the Virginia Theological Seminary Employee Handbook applicable to all Seminary employees, the Seminary provides staff members the following leaves of absence:

Vacation. The Seminary provides full-time staff members who have completed 90 days of employment and who are not assigned to the Butterfly House or the Caterpillar Club with vacation from work (The Butterfly House or the Caterpillar Club employees have a specific vacation plan that aligns with the mission of the Center. In general, each employee receives four weeks off during the summer months). Currently, the Seminary provides eligible full-time staff members vacation days on the following schedule:

Length of Service	Annual Accrual (workdays)
90 days to 5 years of continuous service	15 days
After 5 years of continuous service	20 days

Such vacation accrues each pay period and is pro-rated over the course of the calendar year. Part-time (<20 hours a week) and temporary staff members and staff members assigned to the Butterfly House or Caterpillar Club do not accrue vacation. Exceptions to this policy may be made at the Seminary's discretion.

Vacation is paid leave. Vacation must be taken in half-day increments unless otherwise approved by management. For the purposes of vacation, a workday is 8 hours. Vacation must be approved by management in order to be taken. Should scheduling conflicts occur, vacation may be granted by management based on a number of factors, including seniority of employment and workload. Vacation should be requested in writing to management as far in advance as possible, but in no event less than two weeks' prior to the anticipated leave date, unless otherwise impracticable (such as an unexpected medical appointment or illness).

Vacation may only be taken after it is accrued, unless alternate arrangements are approved by management. The maximum amount of vacation carryover from year to year is 10 days for all employees regardless of years of continuous service. On July 1 of each calendar year, up to 10 unused vacation days will carry over to the subsequent year. Vacation does not accrue during unpaid leaves of absence or other periods of inactive service. Vacation is not counted for the purpose of calculating a staff member's overtime hours of work or overtime premiums. Unused vacation, if available, will be paid out to the employee at separation of employment up to a maximum of 10 days; any remaining vacation is forfeited upon separation of employment. Requests to take unearned vacation will generally be denied, but the staff member may be allowed to take time off without pay at the discretion of the Seminary with prior written approval. If unearned vacation is allowed, it will be deducted from future earned vacation. If the staff member leaves the Seminary prior to paying back the unearned vacation time, by the staff member's signature on the acknowledgment below, the unearned but used and paid vacation time will be deducted from his or her final paycheck.

Sick Leave. The School provides full-time staff members with paid sick leave for an absence due to illness. Currently, the School provides full-time staff members 10 days of paid sick leave per fiscal year. Such sick leave accrues annually on July 1. The School may in some instances require a physician's note for each period of leave. Sick leave may only be taken after it is accrued, unless alternate arrangements are approved by management in writing. The maximum amount of sick leave carryover is 110 days. At fiscal yearend, unused sick days at or below the maximum accrual amount will carry over to the subsequent fiscal year. Once the maximum accrual amount has been reached (110 days), no additional sick leave will be accrued until previously accrued sick leave is used. Sick leave does not accrue during unpaid leaves of absence or other periods of inactive service. Sick leave is not counted for the purpose of calculating a staff member's overtime hours of work or overtime premiums. Unused sick leave has no cash value and will not be paid out at any time, including at separation of employment.

Sick leave may be granted for family as well as personal illness. A staff member who wishes to use sick leave for family or personal illness or medical appointments must contact their department head to request sick leave as early as possible. If a staff member is unable to work due to sickness for 3 consecutive days, the Seminary may require certification of illness from a healthcare provider upon the staff member's return. If unearned sick leave is allowed, it will be deducted from future earned sick leave. If the staff member leaves the Seminary prior to paying back the unearned sick leave, by his or her signature on the acknowledgment below, the unearned but used and paid sick leave will be deducted from his or her final paycheck.

Personal Days. The Seminary provides full-time staff members who are not assigned to the Butterfly House or the Caterpillar Club with 2 personal days per fiscal year. Personal days accrue annually on July 1. Part-time and temporary staff members do not accrue personal days.

Personal days are paid leave. Personal days must be taken in full-day increments unless otherwise approved by management. Personal days must be approved by management in order to be taken. Should scheduling conflicts occur, personal days may be granted by management based on a number of factors, including seniority of employment and workload. Personal days should be requested in writing to management as far in advance as possible.

Personal days do not carry over from year to year. Personal days are not counted for the purpose of calculating a staff member's overtime hours of work or overtime premiums. Unused personal days have no cash value and will not be paid out at any time, including at separation of employment. Requests to take unearned personal days will generally be denied, but the staff member may be allowed to take time off without pay at the discretion of the Seminary with prior written approval. If unearned personal days are allowed, they will be deducted from future earned personal days. If the staff member leaves the Seminary prior to paying back the unearned personal days, by his or her signature on the acknowledgment below, the unearned but used and paid personal days will be deducted from their final paycheck.

Bereavement Leave. Regular, full-time staff members may be eligible for up to 5 days of paid leave for the death of a spouse, domestic partner, parent, child, grandparent, grandchild, sibling, in-law, step-relative or any other relative living in the same household. Regular, full-time staff members may also be eligible for 2 days of paid leave to attend the funeral of any other relative. Staff members requesting bereavement leave should provide the Seminary with as much notice as is reasonable and practical under the circumstances. Bereavement leave is not guaranteed to be approved and does not carry over from year to year. Therefore, bereavement leave has no cash value and will not be paid out at any time, including at separation of employment.

[signature page to follow]

IV. ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I acknowledge that I have received a copy of Virginia Theological Seminary's Staff Benefits Manual. I understand that it is my responsibility to read the entire manual and understand the policies contained in it. If I have a question concerning any policy or information contained in the manual, I will discuss it with Seminary management. I agree to abide by the policies and information contained in this manual, as well as any revisions to it. I understand that the manual is not a contract between the Seminary and any of its employees, including me, that the manual does not create an express or implied contract between me and the Seminary and that the manual and any of its provisions are not to be interpreted as a contract. Rather, the manual contains information about the key employment policies of Virginia Theological Seminary. I also understand that the Seminary retains the right to change, modify, delete or add to the policies and information contained in this manual at any time, with or without prior notice.

Employee Signature

Print Name

Date